



In the vast landscapes of North America, the American Bison, also known as buffalo, stands out with its distinctive features. These majestic creatures are built like brawny, furry tanks with large heads, humped shoulders and a scruffy beard that would make any hipster jealous. Bisons have dark brown, coarse hair that can grow very long, especially in the winter to keep them warm. Their sharp, curved horns sticking out on either side of their massive heads are always ready for action, giving them a fierce look.



While their fierce looks can be intimidating, bison are real softies when it comes to their favourite food - grass. They love grazing in open grasslands, forests, and plains across North America, chomping on grass, herbs, shrubs and twigs. Just like how we humans have our daily routine, bison spend their days eating in the morning and evening, and resting during the day. And did you know? In winter, they use their big heads like a snowplow to clear the snow and reach the delicious grass underneath!

Speaking of snow, American Bison are quite the survivalists, bearing the harsh winters and hot summers. Their life begins as a 'red dog', which is what we call a baby bison because of its reddish-brown coat. As they grow, their coat darkens, and they learn to become part of the herd, which is like a big family of bison living, moving and growing together. Bison live up to 15 years in the wild, and during this time, they play a crucial role in the ecosystem, helping other animals and plants flourish too.



Bison don't just help nature, they've played a significant role in human history too. Native American tribes have revered the bison for thousands of years, using every part of the animal for food, clothes, and tools. Unfortunately, this led to them being over-hunted, but thanks to conservation efforts, their numbers are slowly increasing. So, the next time you see a bison, remember, they're not just big, furry animals, they're superheroes of the wild!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What is the favorite food of American Bisons?
A. Fruits B. Insects C. Meat D. Grass
- 2) Who has revered the bison for thousands of years?
A. Ancient Egyptians B. Roman emperors
C. Native American tribes D. Medieval knights
- 3) What is a baby Bison called?
A. Baby Bison B. Puppy C. Red dog D. Calf
- 4) Where can you usually find bison grazing?
A. Mountains and cliffs B. Lakes and swamps
C. Open grasslands, forests, and plains D. Deserts and wastelands
- 5) What is the shape of the bison's horns?
A. Curved B. Straight C. Branching D. Circular
- 6) When do Bisons usually eat?
A. In the afternoon B. At night
C. In the morning and evening D. At midnight
- 7) What happened to the Bison due to over-hunting?
A. They migrated to different regions B. They became extinct
C. They evolved to become faster D. Their numbers decreased
- 8) How do American Bisons find grass in winter?
A. They use their big heads to clear the snow B. They eat the snow
C. They dig with their hooves D. They eat tree bark instead of grass
- 9) How long can a bison live in the wild?
A. Up to 30 years B. Up to 25 years
C. Up to 5 years D. Up to 15 years
- 10) What is another name for the American Bison?
A. Northern Bears B. Fur Dogs C. Caribou D. Buffalo

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "We are more of an aquatic species, spending most of our time in water."
- 12) "In winters, I use my head to bulldoze away snow and find food. It's my secret superpower!"
- 13) "Guess what, when I was little, I was called a 'red dog' because I had a reddish-brown coat."
- 14) "Our herd is like a big family. We live, move and grow together."
- 15) "I hibernate for the entire winter, just like bears!"
- 16) "Contrary to popular belief, I live in total solitude."
- 17) "Our coarse hair always remains short all year long."



- 18) "I actually live until I'm 100 years old! I guess I just age gracefully."
- 19) "Our lifespan is typically about 5 to 7 years in the wild."
- 20) "Don't let my big horns scare you, we bison are vegetarians. I just love munching on grass and shrubs."
- 21) "I hate open spaces. Forests are what make me feel at home."
- 22) "We've been part of American history for a long time. Native Americans used us for food, clothes, and tools!"

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 23) A herd is a group of bison that live, move, and grow together.
- 24) The way bison can survive in both freezing winter and scorching summer is amazing.
- 25) Bison calves are born with a reddish-brown coat.
- 26) Seeing bison use their heads like snowplows is such a funny and cute sight.
- 27) Bison primarily consume grass, but also eat herbs, shrubs, and twigs.
- 28) It's fascinating that Native American tribes used every part of the bison for their needs.
- 29) During their life in the wild, bison live for up to 15 years.
- 30) Bison's daily life includes eating during the morning and evening, and resting during the day.
- 31) The long, sharp horns of American bison make them look fierce.
- 32) Bison, with their thick coats, are the most stylish animals in the wild.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 33) Over-hunting led to bison numbers decreasing.
- 34) Bison can live up to 35 years in the wild.
- 35) Bison can live up to 15 years in the wild.
- 36) American bison have fur that is white and silky.
- 37) Bison rest during the day.
- 38) Bison mostly eat fish and mice.
- 39) American bison live only in the northern part of North America.
- 40) Bison mostly rest during the night and forage during the day.
- 41) A baby bison is called a red dog.
- 42) Bison graze on grass and twigs.

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 43) Bison can run up to 30 miles per hour.
- 44) Do American bison have a hump on their back?
- 45) Bison have a shaggy coat of fur.
- 46) American bison are also known as buffalo.
- 47) Do American bison live in herds?
- 48) Are American bison native to North America?



American Bison

Name: _____

1. _____ 26. _____
2. _____ 27. _____
3. _____ 28. _____
4. _____ 29. _____
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|-----|----------------|-----|----------------------|
| 1. | <u>D</u> | 26. | <u>opinion</u> |
| 2. | <u>C</u> | 27. | <u>fact</u> |
| 3. | <u>C</u> | 28. | <u>opinion</u> |
| 4. | <u>C</u> | 29. | <u>fact</u> |
| 5. | <u>A</u> | 30. | <u>fact</u> |
| 6. | <u>C</u> | 31. | <u>opinion</u> |
| 7. | <u>D</u> | 32. | <u>opinion</u> |
| 8. | <u>A</u> | 33. | <u>true</u> |
| 9. | <u>D</u> | 34. | <u>false</u> |
| 10. | <u>D</u> | 35. | <u>true</u> |
| 11. | <u>Not</u> | 36. | <u>false</u> |
| 12. | <u>Would</u> | 37. | <u>true</u> |
| 13. | <u>Would</u> | 38. | <u>false</u> |
| 14. | <u>Would</u> | 39. | <u>false</u> |
| 15. | <u>Not</u> | 40. | <u>false</u> |
| 16. | <u>Not</u> | 41. | <u>true</u> |
| 17. | <u>Not</u> | 42. | <u>true</u> |
| 18. | <u>Not</u> | 43. | <u>declarative</u> |
| 19. | <u>Not</u> | 44. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 20. | <u>Would</u> | 45. | <u>declarative</u> |
| 21. | <u>Not</u> | 46. | <u>declarative</u> |
| 22. | <u>Would</u> | 47. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 23. | <u>fact</u> | 48. | <u>interrogative</u> |
| 24. | <u>opinion</u> | | |
| 25. | <u>fact</u> | | |